TOCO TOUCAN

Ramphastos toco

What can it see, hear, or feel?
Its long bill reaches fruit on thin branches, its eyes spot ripe color, and its ears hear other toucans.

Where does it live — and why?
It lives in forest edges and open woodland, where tree holes make safe nests high up.

How does it send messages?
It gives a deep, repeated croaking call, clacks its bill at rivals, and poses to show mood.

What does it do when something changes?
When alarmed, it flies in a quick, bouncing path and watches the danger from a high perch.

How does it learn?
Young toucans beg loudly for food and follow their parents to learn which trees hold ripe fruit.

How does it have babies?
A pair lays two to four eggs in a tree hole, and both parents take turns sitting and feeding.

What are its limits?
It cannot carve its own nest, so cutting down big old trees takes away its only nesting site.

What does this teach us?
Its big bill reaches food, signals to other birds, and helps keep its body cool.

Think About This

If your beak was huge but very light, how would you use it to reach the fruit you want?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.